

include a manifest will be implicitly added to the application cache. Thus, there's no need to list every page in your manifest. A manifest file must be served with the mime-type text/cache-manifest. You may need to add a custom file type to your web server or .htaccess configuration.

Structure of a manifest file

A manifest can have three distinct sections: CACHE, NETWORK, and FALLBACK.

- ▶ **CACHE** - This is the default section for entries. Files listed under this header (or immediately after the CACHE MANIFEST) will be explicitly cached after they're downloaded for the first time.
- ▶ **NETWORK** - Files listed under this section are white-listed resources that require a connection to the server. All requests to these resources bypass the cache, even if the user is offline. Wildcards may be used.
- ▶ **FALLBACK** - An optional section specifying fallback pages if a resource is inaccessible. The first URI is the resource, the second is the fallback. Both URIs must be relative and from the same origin as the manifest file. Wildcards may be used.

A simple manifest may look something like this:

CACHE MANIFEST

index.html

stylesheet.css

images/logo.png

scripts/main.js

- ▶ This example will cache four files on the page that specifies this manifest file.
- ▶ There are a couple of things to note:
- ▶ The CACHE MANIFEST string is the first line and is required.
- ▶ Sites are limited to 5MB worth of cached data. However, if you are writing an app for the Chrome Web Store, using the unlimitedStorage removes that restriction.
- ▶ If the manifest file or a resource specified in it fails to download, the entire cache update process fails. The browser will keep using the old application cache in the event of failure.

You must modify the manifest file itself to inform the browser to refresh cached files. Creating a comment line with a generated version number, hash of your files, or timestamp is one way to ensure users have the latest

Note

These sections can be listed in any order and each section can appear more than one in a single manifest.